ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 14

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Sinhala Alphabet

මගේ පළමු සිංහල හෝඩිය

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 50 Sinhala Letters with English Phonetics

අ ආ ඇ ක ග ම

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Sinhala Alphabet — මගේ පළමු සිංහල හෝඩිය
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 14

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Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
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First edition, 2026.

Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

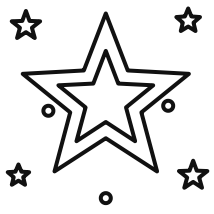
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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

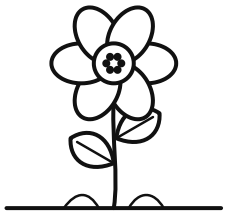


This book belongs to
මේ පොත මගේ

I started learning Sinhala on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 14 is Sinhala. More languages of the subcontinent are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon".
- **h after a letter** (*kh, gh, th, dh, bh*) means "add a puff of breath" — hold a tissue in front of your mouth and watch it move! It never means the English "th" of "the".
- **a** is the short sound in "about". Every consonant carries it: කා = *ka*.
- **æ** is the 'a' in "cat"; **ææ** is the same sound held longer. **ē** and **ō** (with a line on top) are long 'ay' and 'oh'; plain **e** and **o** are short.
- **A dot under t, d, n, l** (*ṭ, ḍ, ṇ, ḷ*) means the tongue curls back; without it, the tongue touches the teeth. In everyday Sinhala, *ṇ* and *ḷ* sound the same as *n* and *l*.
- **nd, mb, ng** in words like *sanda*, *amba* stand for the half-nasal letters: say the *n* or *m* very lightly.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Sinhala name** written in Sinhala (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Sinhala phonetics* shows how the sound is built the way Sinhala children learn it, for example ක් + අ = කා, or a vowel sign (*pilla*) added to a consonant. Sinhala children call each letter by its sound plus *-yanna*: කා is *kayanna*, මා is *mayanna*.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard spoken Sinhala of Sri Lanka.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Sinhala! සිංහල

sinhala — the Sinhala word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **17 million people** speak Sinhala as their first language, and millions more speak it as a second language.[3]

Where?
On the island of **Sri Lanka** in the Indian Ocean. Sinhala and Tamil are the two official languages of Sri Lanka.

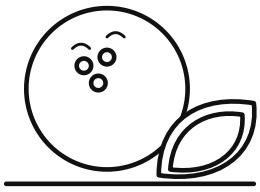
How is it written?
From **left to right**, in its own round, curly script. Long ago people wrote on dried **palm leaves** with a sharp metal pen — round letters did not tear the leaf!

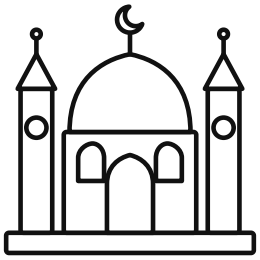
How many letters?
The full alphabet, the හෝඩිය *hōḍiya*, has about **60 letters**. This book teaches the **50** used most.

Sounds to listen for
Sinhala has the ‘a’ of “cat” (ඇ) and four **half-nasal** letters: ඟ ඬ ඳ ඹ — ‘ng’, ‘nḍ’, ‘nd’ and ‘mb’ said as one sound.

Did you know?
Sri Lanka is famous for its **tea** (තේ *tē*), its coconuts (පොල් *pol*) and its crispy **hoppers** (ආප්ප *aappa*).







THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Sinhala Alphabet හෝඩිය

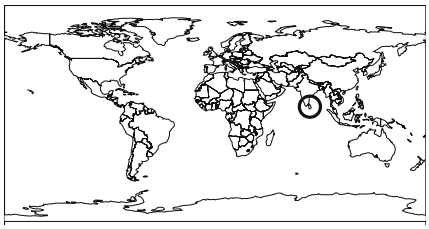
16 vowels — ස්වර

අ *ayanna*	ආ *aayanna*	ඇ *æyanna*	ඈ *ææyanna*	ඉ *iyanna*	ඊ *eeyanna*	උ *uyanna*
ඌ *ooyanna*	ඍ *ruyanna*	එ *eyanna*	ඒ *ēyanna*	ඓ *aiyanna*	ඔ *oyanna*	ඕ *ōyanna*
ඖ *auyanna*	අං *binduva*					

34 consonants — ව්‍යඤ්ජන

ක *kayanna*	ඛ *mahaapraana kayanna*	ග *gayanna*	ඝ *mahaapraana gayanna*	ඟ *sanyaka gayanna*	ච *chayanna*	ඡ *mahaapraana chayanna*
ජ *jayanna*	ට *ṭayanna*	ඩ *ḍayanna*	ණ *muurdhaja ṇayanna*	ඬ *sanyaka ḍayanna*	ත *tayanna*	ථ *mahaapraana tayanna*
ද *dayanna*	ධ *mahaapraana dayanna*	න *dantaja nayanna*	ඳ *sanyaka dayanna*	ප *payanna*	ඵ *mahaapraana payanna*	බ *bayanna*
භ *mahaapraana bayanna*	ම *mayanna*	ඹ *amba bayanna*	ය *yayanna*	ර *rayanna*	ල *dantaja layanna*	ව *vayanna*
ශ *taaluja shayanna*	ෂ *muurdhaja shayanna*	ස *dantaja sayanna*	හ *hayanna*	ළ *muurdhaja ḷayanna*	ෆ *fayanna*	

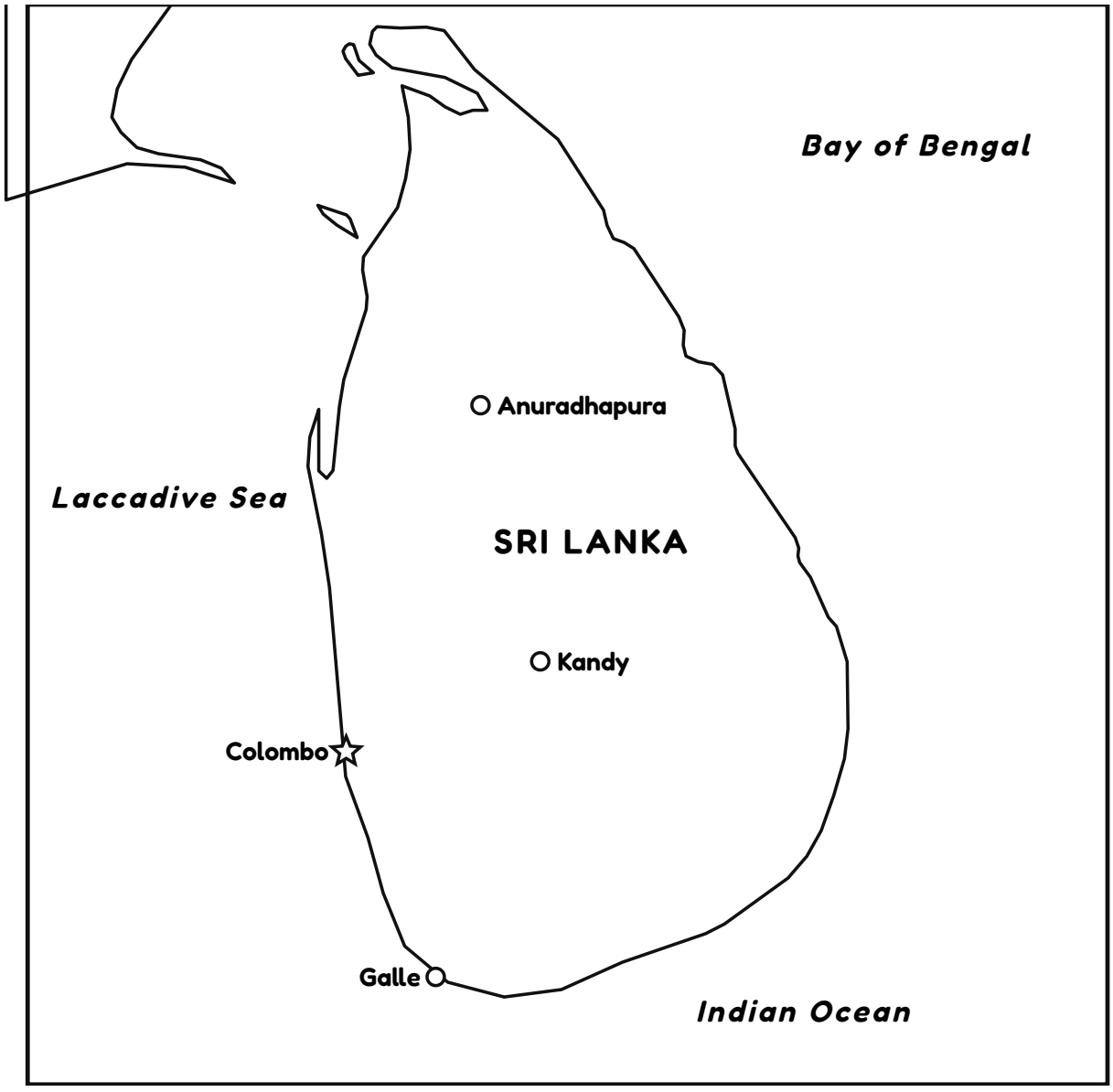
Read the alphabet left to right, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Sri Lanka on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Sinhala spoken?



Color it: the island **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Sri Lanka is an island shaped like a drop of water. Colombo ★ is its biggest city, and the capital, Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte, is right next to it. Sinhala is spoken all over the island, in towns such as Kandy, Galle and Anuradhapura.

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PART 1

The Vowels ස්වර

svara — “voice letters”

Vowels are the sounds you make with your mouth open: *a*, *aa*, *i*, *ee*, *u*, *oo*… This book has **16 vowels**.

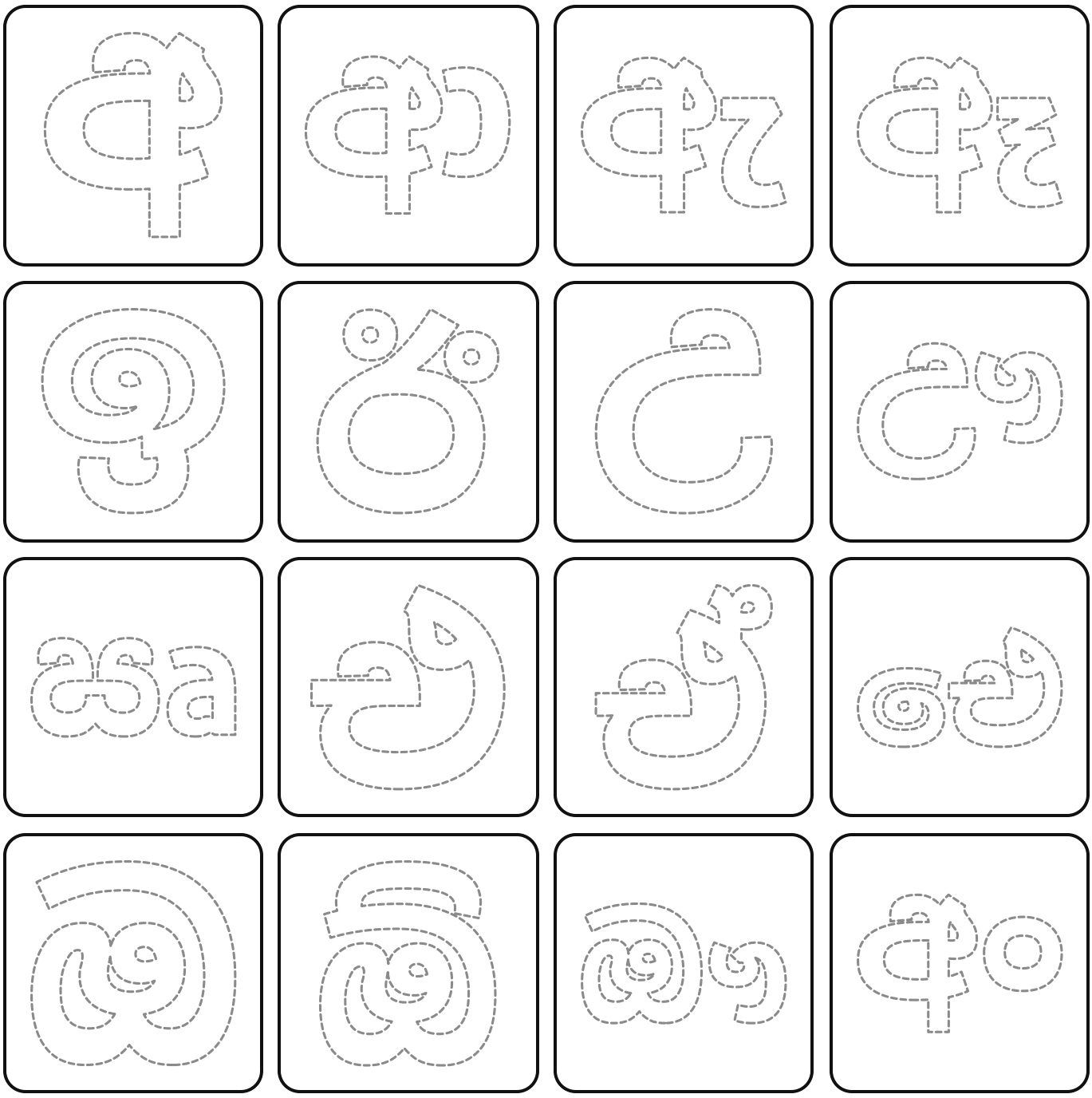
A vowel has **two shapes**. At the start of a word it is a full letter. After a consonant it becomes a small **vowel sign** that holds on to the consonant: ක + ා = කා. Sinhala has two vowels that most other scripts of South Asia do not: ඇ ඈ *(æ, ææ)*, the ‘a’ of “cat”. The last one, ං, is the *binduva* sign that adds ‘ng’.

Vowel	Name	Sign	With ක
අ	*ayanna*	—	ක
ආ	*aayanna*	ා	කා
ඇ	*æyanna*	ැ	කැ
ඈ	*ææyanna*	ෑ	කෑ
ඉ	*iyanna*	ි	කි
ඊ	*eeyanna*	ී	කී
උ	*uyanna*	ු	කු
ඌ	*ooyanna*	ූ	කූ
ඍ	*ruyanna*	ෘ	කෘ
එ	*eyanna*	ෙ	කෙ
ඒ	*ēyanna*	ේ	කේ
ඓ	*aiyanna*	ෛ	කෛ
ඔ	*oyanna*	ො	කො
ඕ	*ōyanna*	ෝ	කෝ
ඖ	*auyanna*	ෞ	කෞ
අං	*binduva*	ං	කං

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels ස්වර

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



අ

NAME · නම

අයන්න

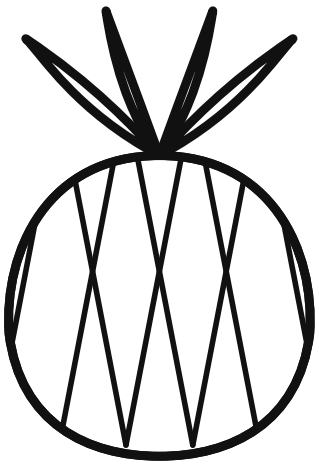
ayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘a’ as in “about”

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

No sign! අ hides inside every consonant: ක = ක් + අ



අ IS FOR

අන්නාසි

annaasi

pineapple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

අ අ අ අ

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ආ

NAME · නම

ආයන්න

aayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'aa' as in "father"

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ා (ඇලපිල්ල)

ක + ා = කා



ආ IS FOR

ආප්ප

aappa

hoppers (crispy bowl pancakes)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ආ ආ ආ ආ

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ඇ

NAME · නම

ඇයන්න

æyanna

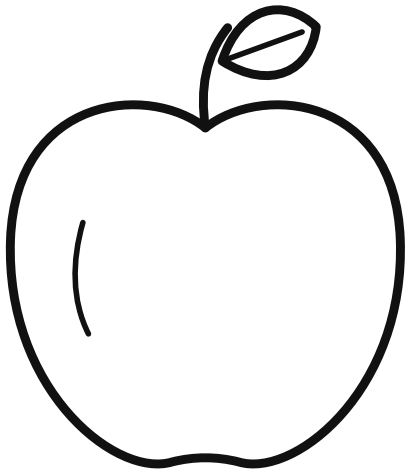
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘æ’ — the ‘a’ in “cat”, short

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ැ (ඇදය)

ක + ැ = කැ



ඇ IS FOR

ඇපල්

æpal

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඇ ඇ ඇ ඇ

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ඈ

NAME · නම

ඈයන්න

ææyanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

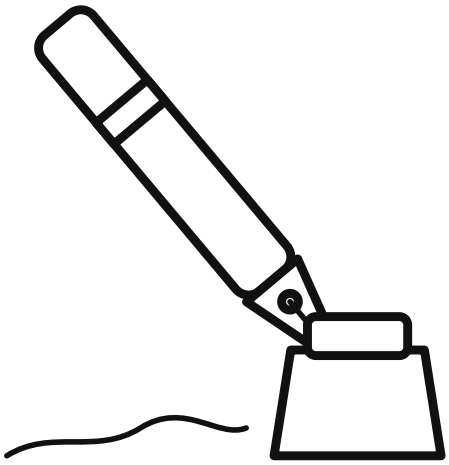
‘ææ’ — the ‘a’ in “cat”, said long

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ෑ (දිග ඇදය)

ක + ෑ = කෑ

This vowel rarely starts a word. Find its sign ෑ in පෑන!



ඈ IS FOR

පෑන

pæænа

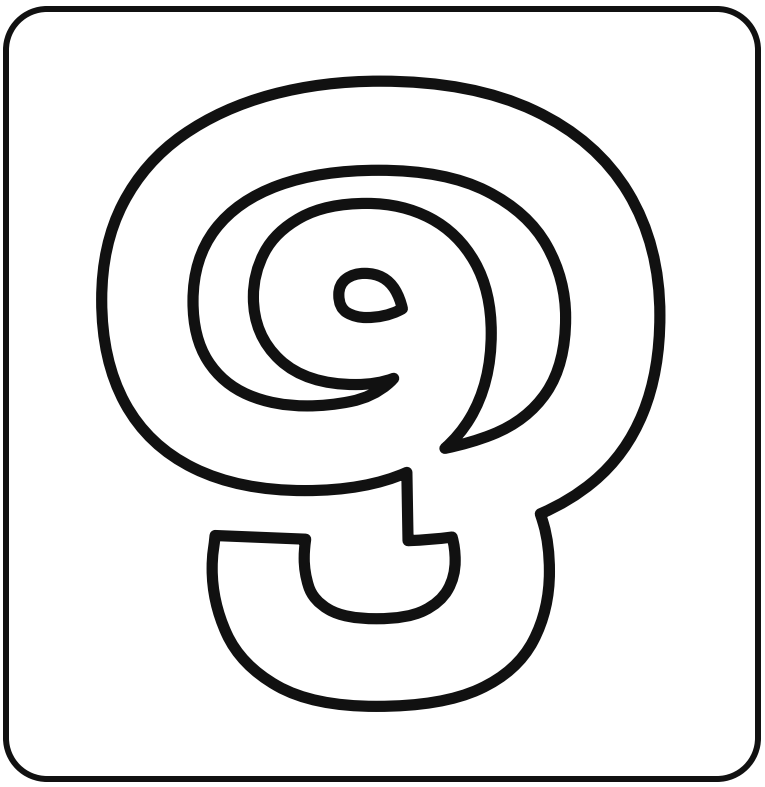
pen

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඈ ඈ ඈ ඈ

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NAME · නම

ඉයන්න

iyanna

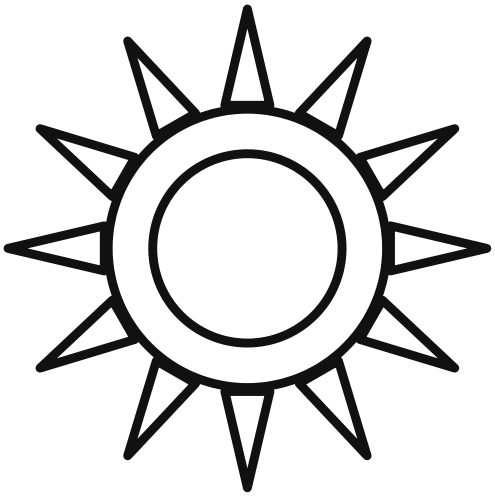
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'i' as in "sit" — short

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ි (ඉස්පිල්ල)

ක + ි = කි



ඉ IS FOR

ඉර

ira

the sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඉ ඉ ඉ ඉ

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ඒ

NAME · නම

ඒයන්න

eeyanna

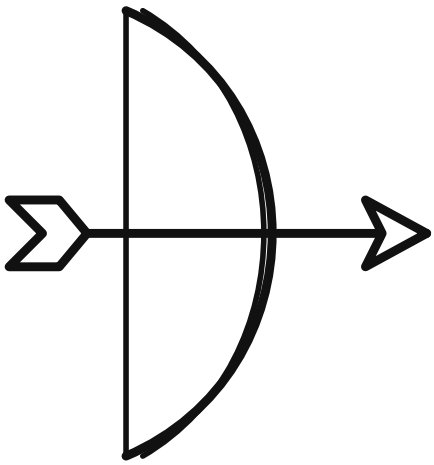
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ee' as in "see" — long

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ී (දිග ඉස්පිල්ල)

ක + ී = කී



ඒ IS FOR

ඒතලය

eetalaya

arrow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඒ ඒ ඒ ඒ

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උ

NAME · නම

උයන්න

uyanna

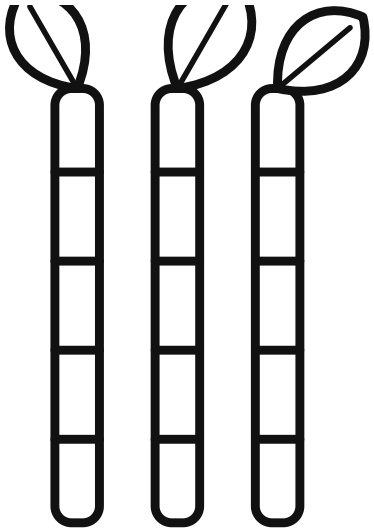
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'u' as in "put" — short

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ු (පාපිල්ල)

ක + ු = කු



උ IS FOR

උක්

uk

sugarcane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

උ උ උ උ

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ඌ

NAME · නම

ඌයන්න

ooyanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

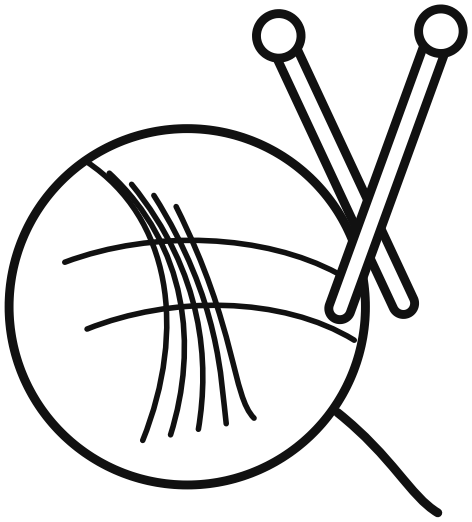
'oo' as in "moon" — long

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ූ (දිග පාපිල්ල)

ක + ූ = කූ

This vowel rarely starts a word. Find its sign ූ in නූල්!



ඌ IS FOR

නූල්

nool

thread

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඌ ඌ ඌ ඌ

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NAME · නම

සෘයන්න

ruyanna

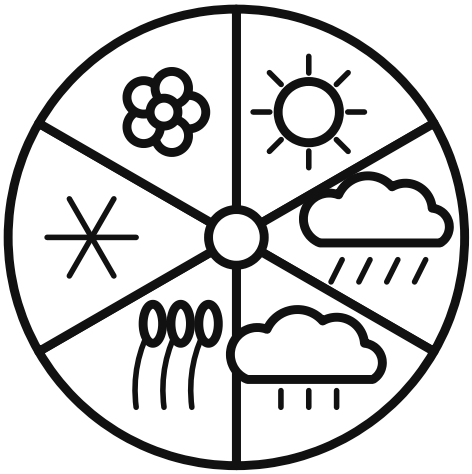
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ru' as in "root" — a vowel from Sanskrit

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

◌ෘ (ගැටයන්න)

ක + ◌ෘ = කෘ



සෘ IS FOR

සෘතුව

rutuva

season

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

සෘ සෘ සෘ සෘ

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eyanna

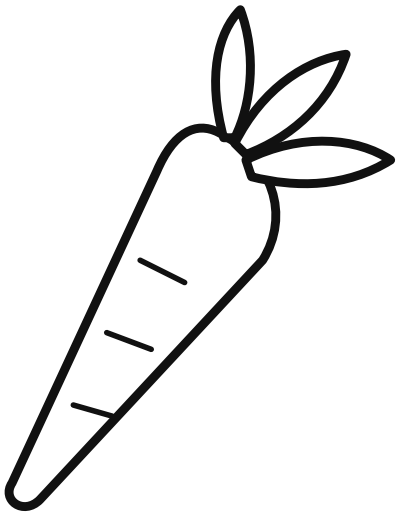
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘e’ as in “bed”

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ෙ (කොම්බුව)

ක + ෙ = කෙ



එ IS FOR

එළවළු

eḷavaḷu

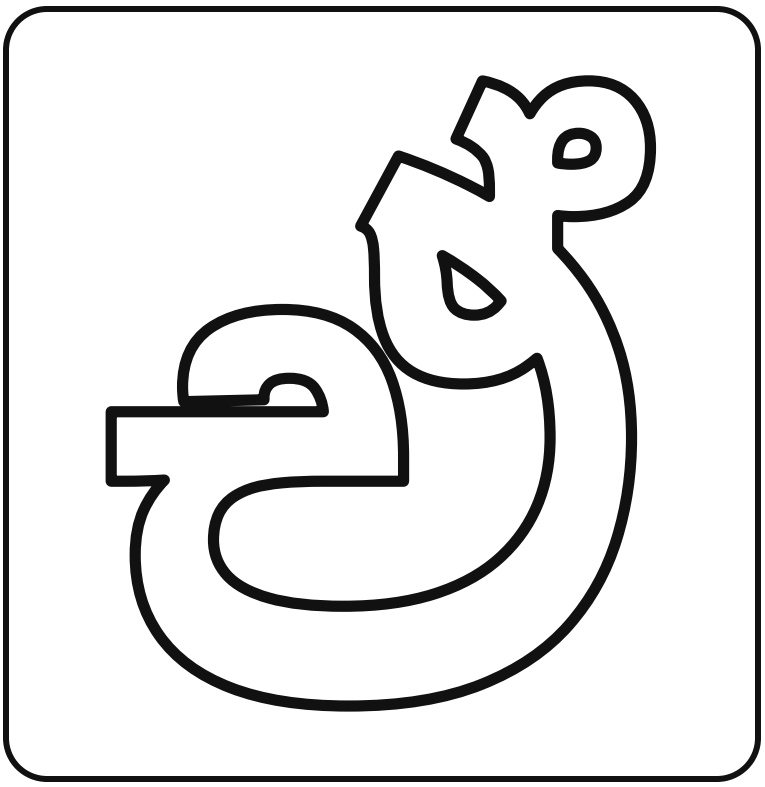
vegetables

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

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ēyanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘ē’ as in “they” (say “ay”)

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ේ (කොම්බුව + හල් කිරීම)

ක + ේ = කේ

This vowel rarely starts a word. Find its sign ේ in තේ! Sri Lanka grows famous tea!



ඒ IS FOR

තේ

tē

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

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aiyanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

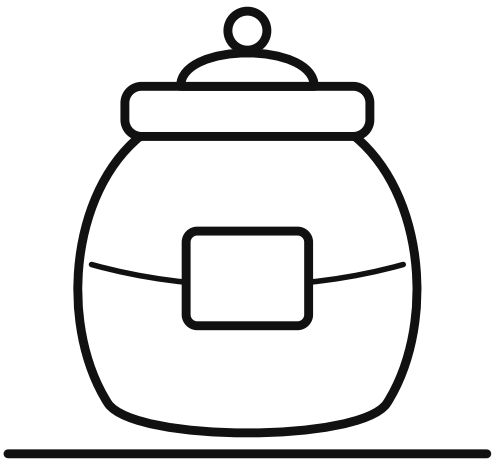
'ai' as in "aisle"

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ෛ (කොම්බු දෙක)

ක + ෛ = කෛ

This vowel rarely starts a word. Find its sign ◌ෛ in තෛලය!



ඓ IS FOR

තෛලය

tailaya

oil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

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oyanna

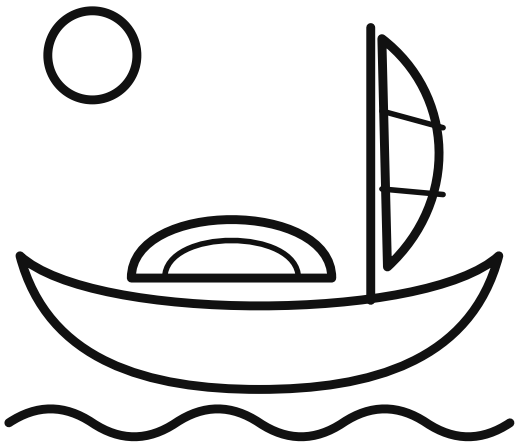
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘o’ as in “on”

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ොා (කොම්බුව + ඇලපිල්ල)

ක + ොා = කොා



ඔ IS FOR

ඔරුව

oruva

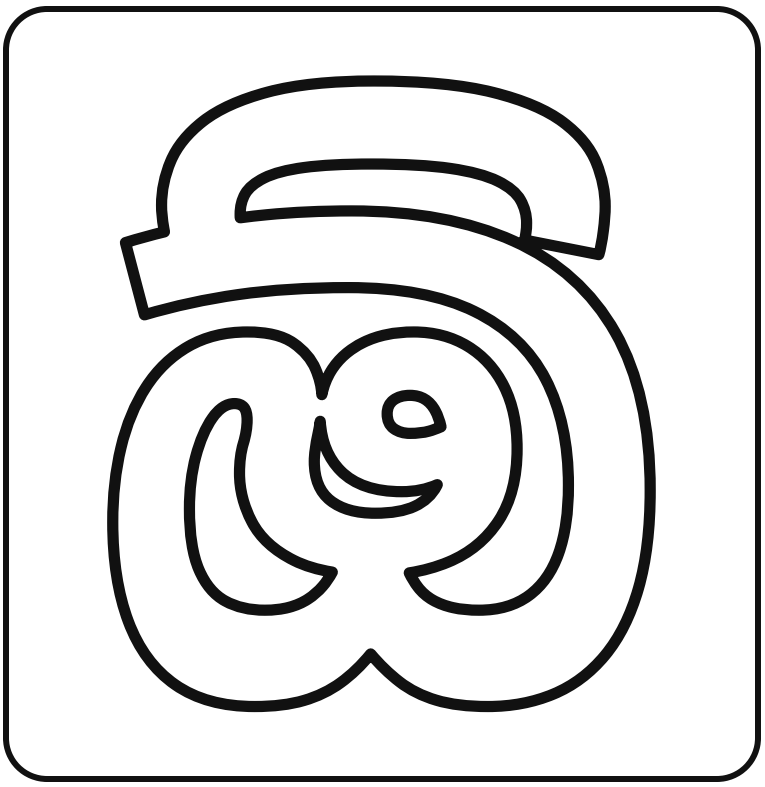
canoe, small boat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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ōyanna

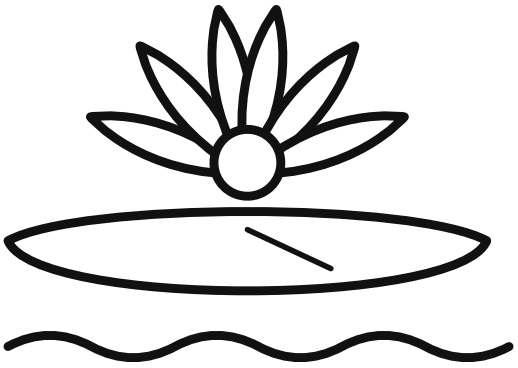
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘ō’ as in “go”

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ෝ (කොම්බුව + ඇලපිල්ල + හල් කිරීම)

ක + ෝ = කෝ



ඕ IS FOR

ඕලු

ōlu

water lily

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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auyanna

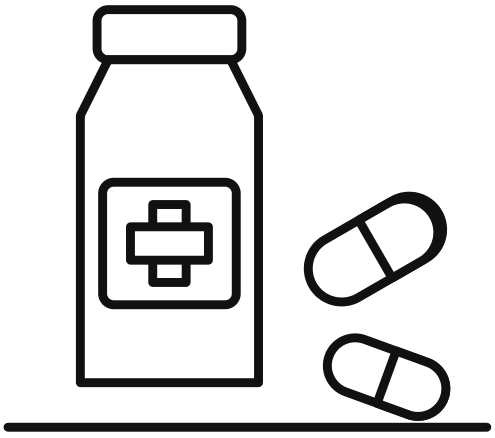
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'au' — like the 'ow' in "owl"

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ෞ (කොම්බුව + ගයනුකිත්ත)

ක + ෞ = කෞ



ඖ IS FOR

ඖෂධ

aushadha

medicine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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අං (බින්දුව)

binduva

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a nasal ‘ng’ after the vowel, as in “sing”

SINHALA PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ං (බින්දුව)

ක + ං = කං



අං IS FOR

අංකය

ankaya

number

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

අං අං අං අං

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PART 2

The Consonants ව්‍යඤ්ජන

vyanjana

Consonants are the sounds made by stopping or squeezing the air: *k, g, ch, j, t, d, p, b*... This book has **34 consonants**. They are the letters children meet most in everyday Sinhala, in the traditional order.

The hidden vowel

Every consonant secretly carries a short vowel *(a)*. That is why ක is said *ka*, not just *k*:

ක් + අ = ක

k + a = ka. The little mark ් (*hal kiriima*) switches the hidden vowel off: ක් says just *k*, as at the end of පොල් *pol* (coconut).

Letter families

ක ඛ ග ඝ ඟ — back of the throat

ච ඡ ජ — middle of the tongue

ට ඩ ණ ඬ — tongue curled back (hard)

ත ථ ද ධ න ඳ — tongue on the teeth (soft)

ප ඵ බ භ ම ඹ — the lips

Half-nasal letters: a Sinhala speciality

ඟ ඬ ඳ ඹ are one letter each, but they sound like a tiny *n* or *m* gliding into the next sound: අඹ *amba* (mango), සඳ *sanda* (moon). Say them quickly, as one sound!

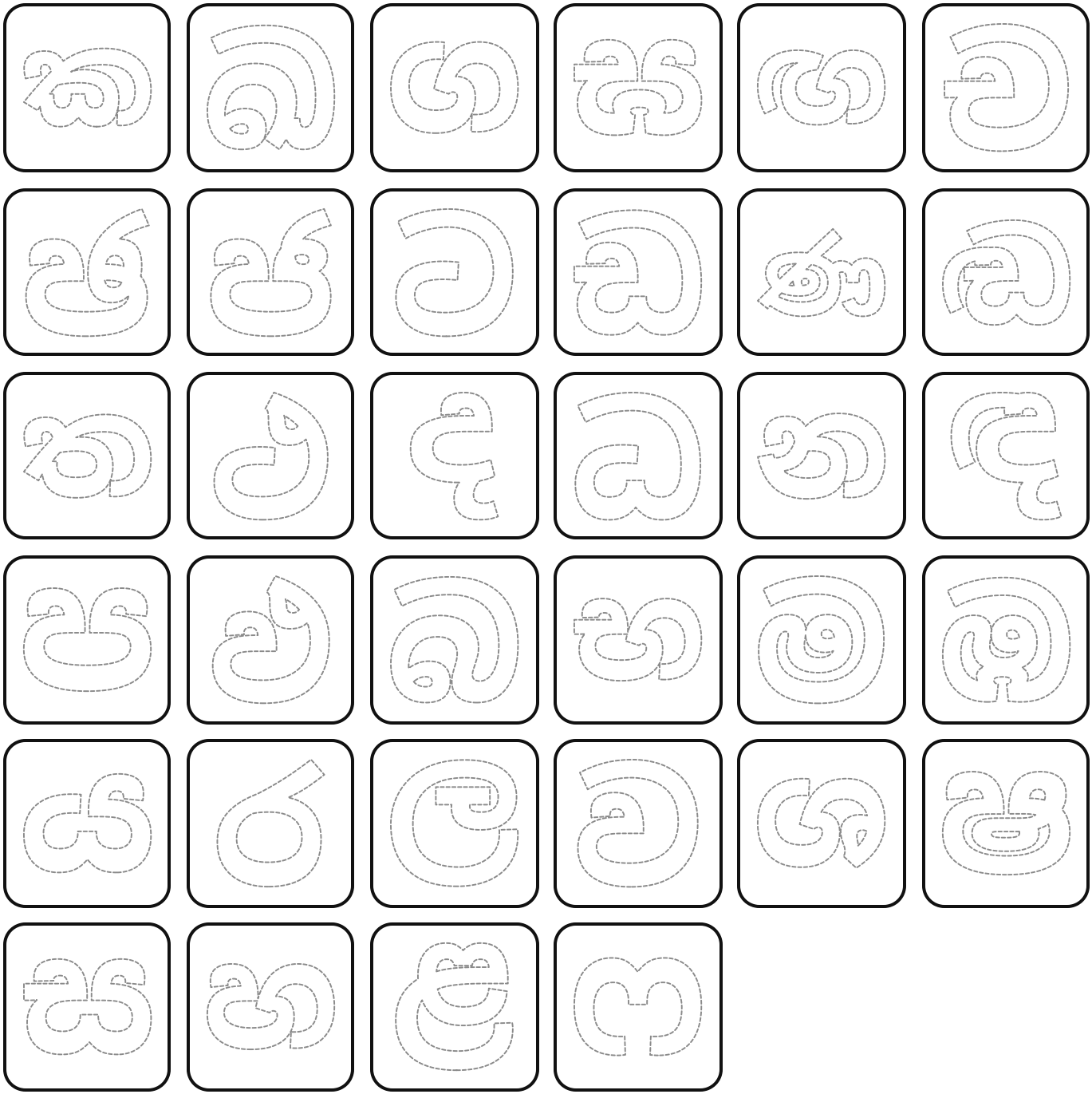
Big-breath letters and rare letters

ඛ ඝ ඡ ඨ ධ ඵ භ are *mahaapraana* (“big breath”) letters, used in words from Sanskrit and Pali. The full Sinhala alphabet has about 60 letters; the rarest — ඞ ඣ ඤ ඦ ඥ ඪ ඬ, the vowels ඍ ඎ ඏ ඐ and the sign ඃ — appear in only a few words, so you will meet them later.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the consonants ව්‍යඤ්ජන

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ක

NAME · නම

කයන්න

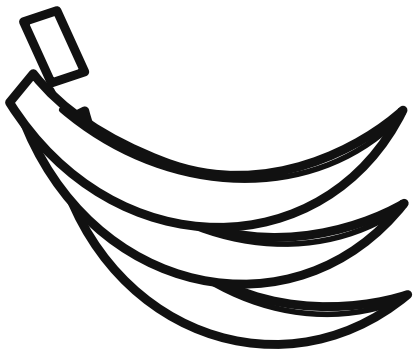
kayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' as in "kite" (no puff of air)

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ක් + අ = ක



ක IS FOR

කෙසෙල්

kesel

banana

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ක ක ක ක

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NAME · නම

මහාප්‍රාණ කයන්න

mahaapraana kayanna

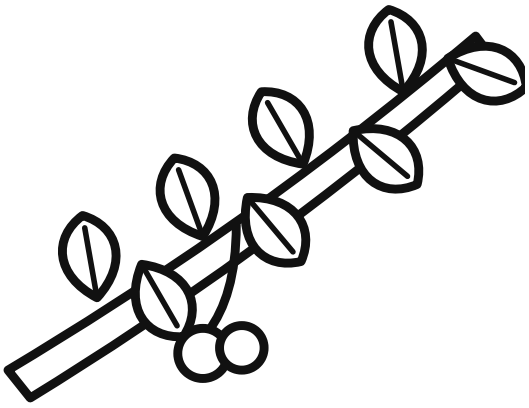
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like ක — in careful speech, add a puff of breath

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඛ් + අ = ඛ

Find ඛ inside ශාඛාව — it hardly ever starts a word.



ඛ IS FOR

ශාඛාව

shaakhaava

branch (of a tree)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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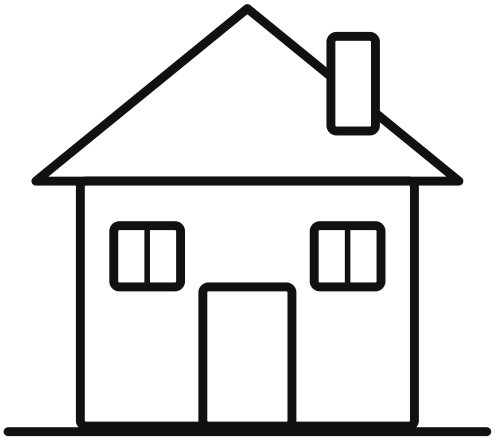
gayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ග් + අ = ග



ග IS FOR

ගෙදර

gedara

home, house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

මහාප්‍රාණ ගයන්න

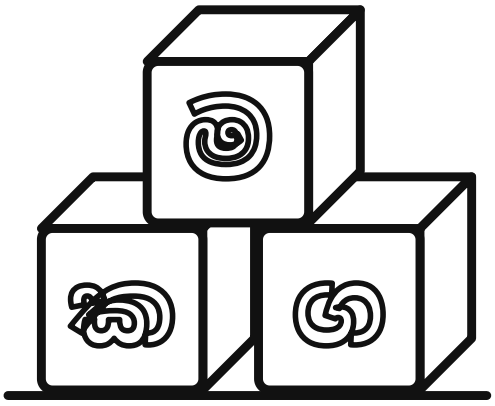
mahaapraana gayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like ග — in careful speech, add a puff of breath

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඝ් + අ = ඝ



ඝ IS FOR

ඝනකය

ghanakaya

cube

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

සඤ්ඤක ගයන්න

sanyaka gayanna

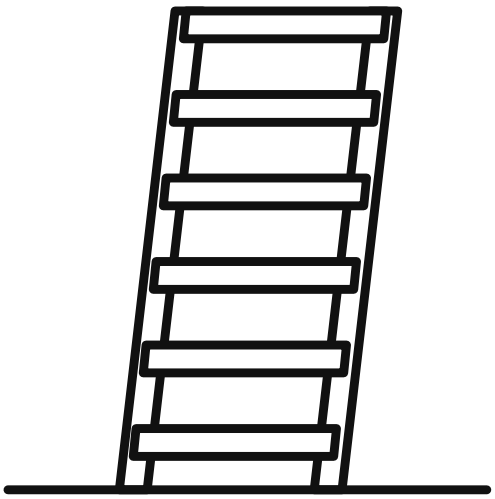
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a half-nasal ‘ng’: a tiny ‘n’ slides into ‘g’, like “finger” said quickly

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඟ් + අ = ඟ

Find ඟ inside ඉණිමඟ — it hardly ever starts a word.



ඟ IS FOR

ඉණිමඟ

iṇimanga

ladder

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

චයන්න

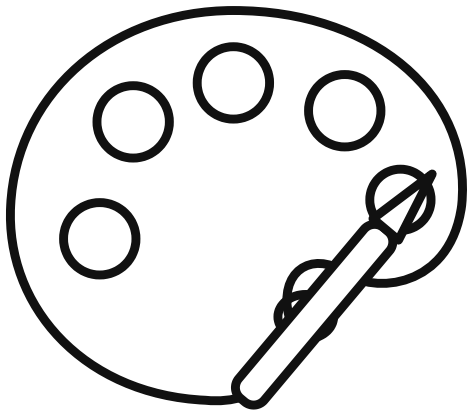
chayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ච් + අ = ච



ච IS FOR

චිත්‍රය

chitraya

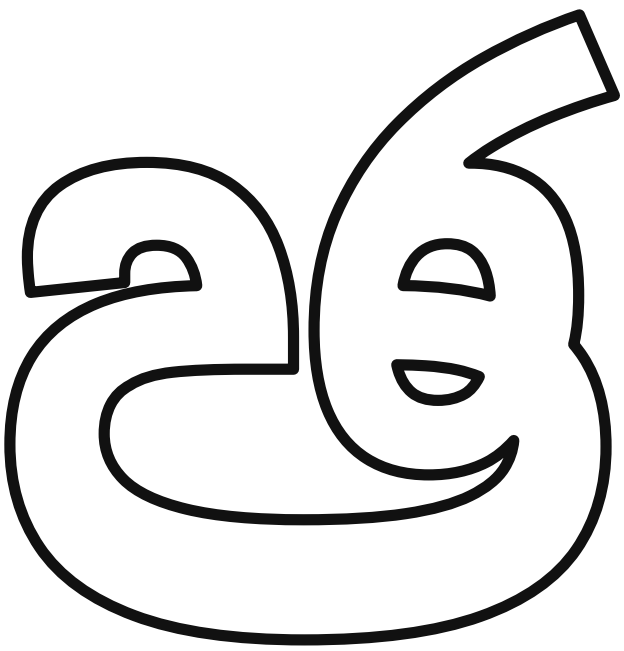
picture, painting

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

මහාප්‍රාණ චයන්න

mahaapraana chayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ch' — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like ච — in careful speech, add a puff of breath

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඡ් + අ = ඡ



ඡ IS FOR

ඡත්‍රය

chhatraya

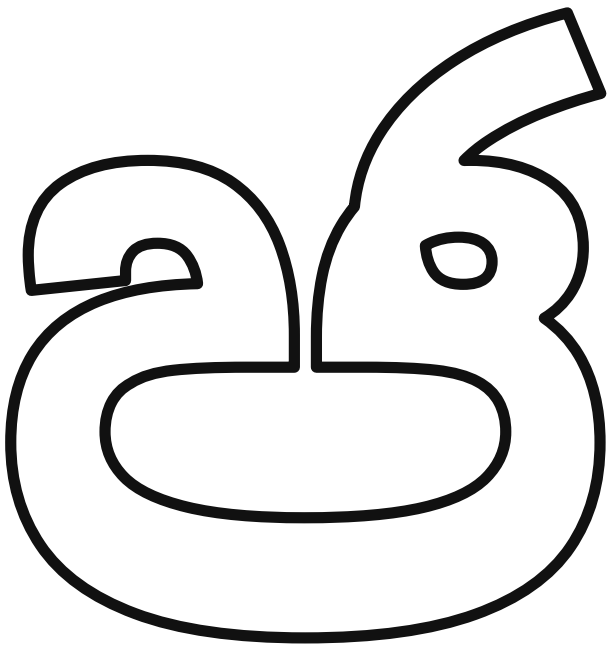
umbrella, parasol

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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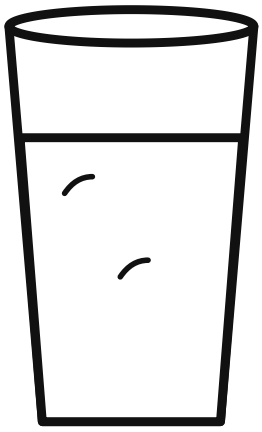
jayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ජ් + අ = ජ



ජ IS FOR

ජලය

jalaya

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

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ṭayanna

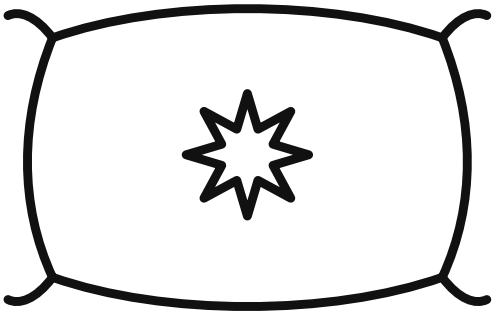
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘t’ — curl your tongue back, as in “top”

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ට් + අ = ට

Find ට inside කොට්ටය — it hardly ever starts a word.



ට IS FOR

කොට්ටය

koṭṭaya

pillow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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ඩ

NAME · නම

ඩයන්න

ḍayanna

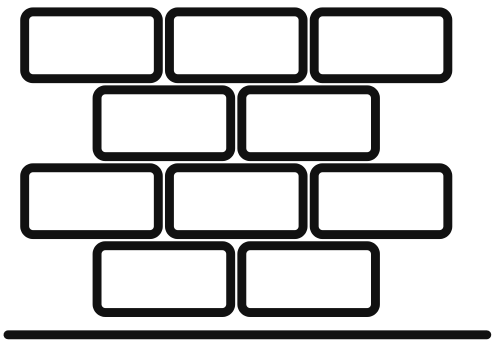
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘d’ — curl your tongue back, as in “dog”

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඩ් + අ = ඩ

Find ඩ inside ගඩොල් — it hardly ever starts a word.



ඩ IS FOR

ගඩොල්

gaḍol

brick

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

මූර්ධජ ණයන්න

muurdhaja ṇayanna

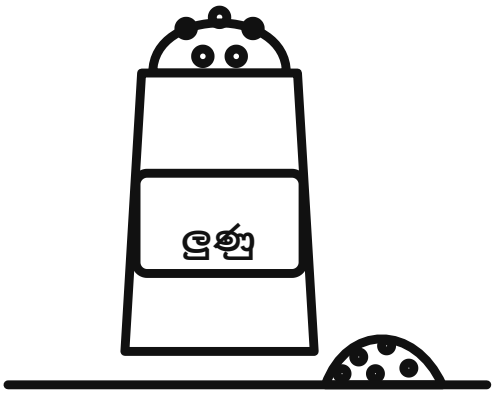
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like න

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ණ් + අ = ණ

Find ණ inside ලුණු — it hardly ever starts a word.



ණ IS FOR

ලුණු

luṇu

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ණ ණ ණ ණ

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ඬ

NAME · නම

සඤ්ඤක ඩයන්න

sanyaka ḍayanna

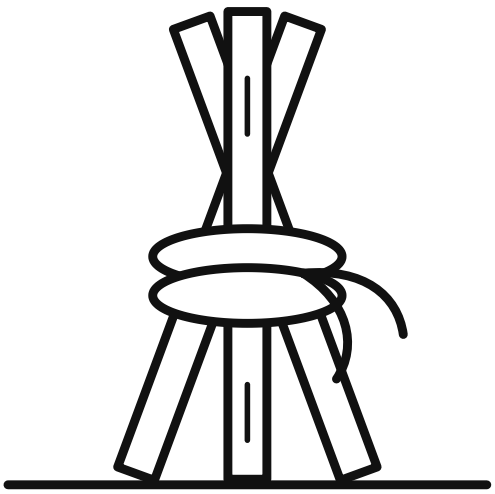
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a half-nasal ‘nḍ’: a tiny ‘n’ slides into a hard ‘ḍ’

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඬ් + අ = ඬ

Find ඬ inside දඬුව — it hardly ever starts a word.



ඬ IS FOR

දඬුව

danḍuva

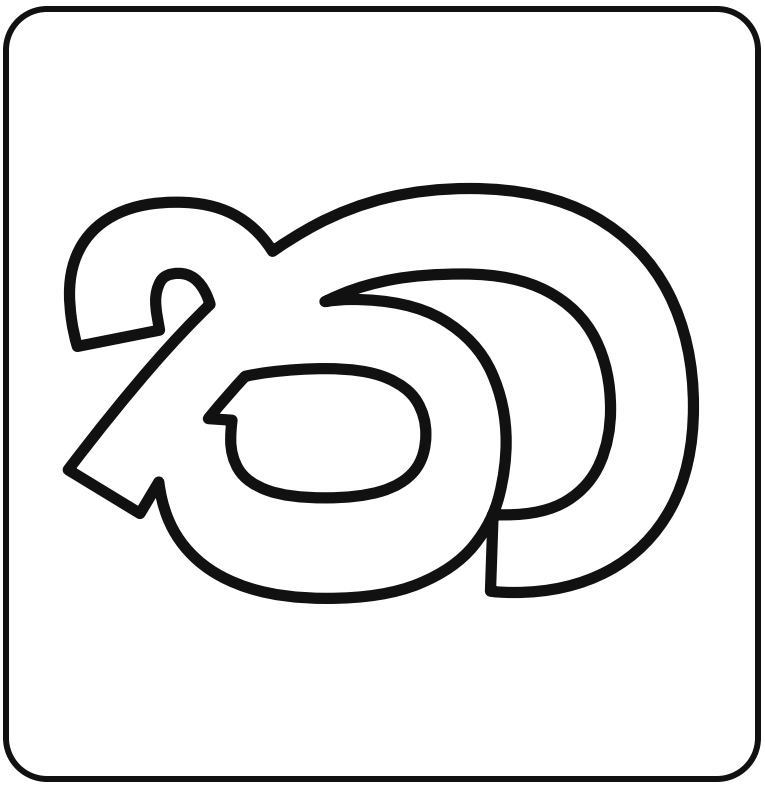
stick, rod

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඬ ඬ ඬ ඬ

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NAME · නම

තයන්න

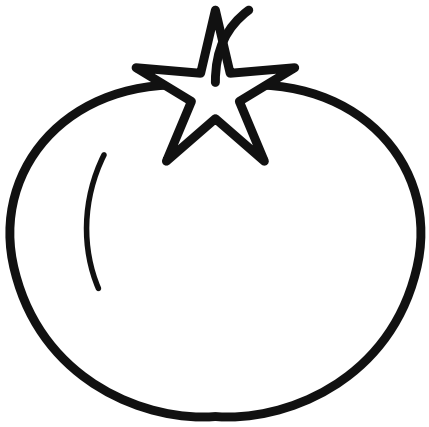
tayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘t’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ත් + අ = ත



ත IS FOR

තක්කාලි

takkaali

tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ත ත ත ත

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ඛ

NAME · නම

මහාප්‍රාණ තයන්න

mahaapraana tayanna

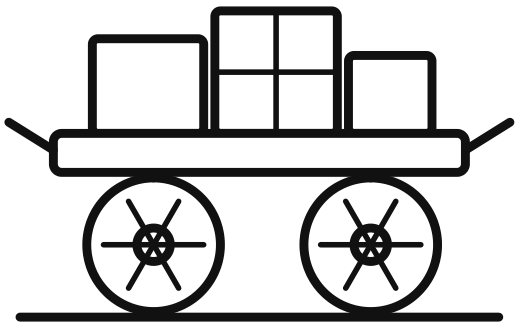
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘t’ — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like ත — in careful speech, add a puff of breath

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ත් + අ = ථ

Find ථ inside රථය — it hardly ever starts a word.



ථ IS FOR

රථය

rathaya

cart, carriage

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඛ ඛ ඛ ඛ

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ද

NAME · නම

දයන්න

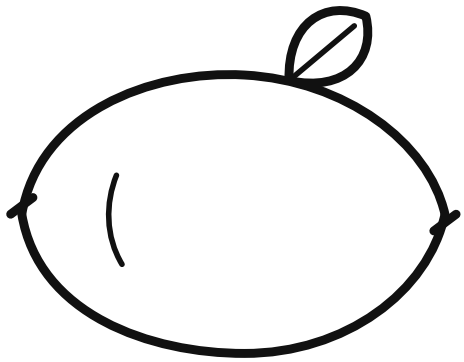
dayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘d’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ද් + අ = ද



ද IS FOR

දෙහි

dehi

lime

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ද ද ද ද

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ධ

NAME · නම

මහාප්‍රාණ දයන්න

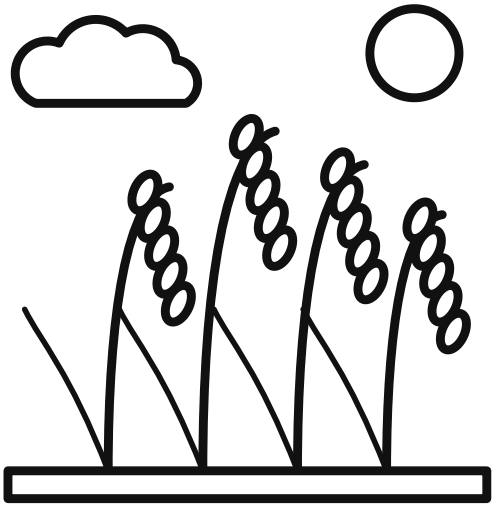
mahaapraana dayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘d’ — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like ද — in careful speech, add a puff of breath

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඩ් + අ = ධ



ධ IS FOR

ධාන්‍ය

dhaanya

grain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ධ ධ ධ ධ

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න

NAME · නම

දන්තජ නයන්න

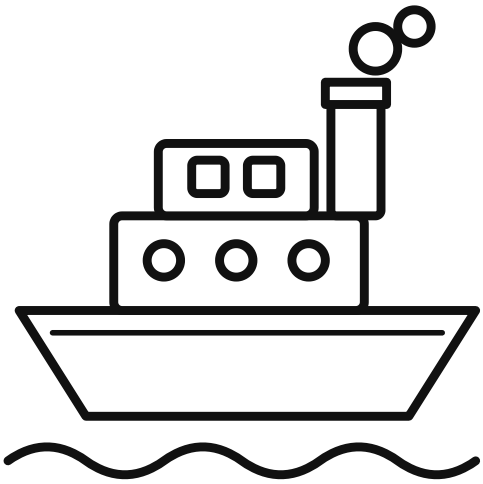
dantaja nayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' as in "net"

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

න් + අ = න



න IS FOR

නැව

næva

ship

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

න න න න

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ඦ

NAME · නම

සඤ්ඤක දයන්න

sanyaka dayanna

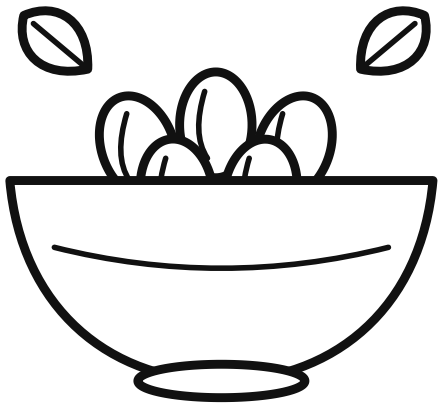
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a half-nasal ‘nd’: a tiny ‘n’ slides into a soft ‘d’, like “candle” said quickly

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඦ් + අ = ඦ

Find ඳ inside ඉඳි — it hardly ever starts a word.



ඳ IS FOR

රට ඉඳි

raṭa indi

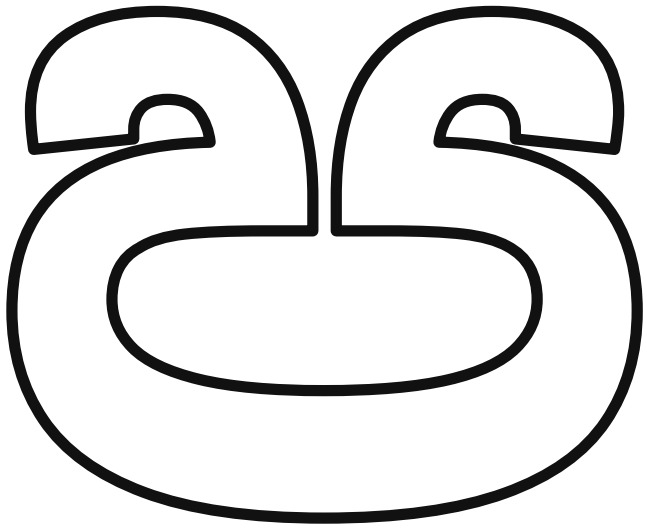
dates

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඳ ඳ ඳ ඳ

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NAME · නම

පයන්න

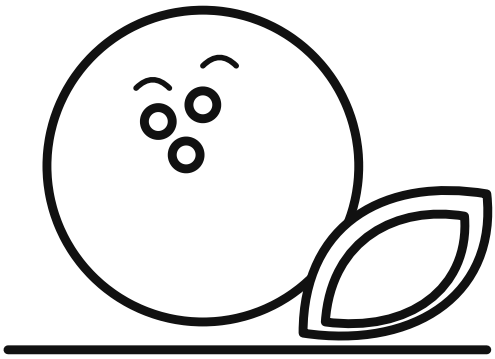
payanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen” (no puff of air)

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ප් + අ = ප



ප IS FOR

පොල්

pol

coconut

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ප ප ප ප

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ඵ

NAME · නම

මහාප්‍රාණ පයන්න

mahaapraana payanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like ප — in careful speech, add a puff of breath

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඵ් + අ = ඵ



ඵ IS FOR

ඵලය

phalaya

fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ඵ ඵ ඵ ඵ

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බ

NAME · නම

බයන්න

bayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'b' as in "ball"

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

බ් + අ = බ



බ IS FOR

බත්

bat

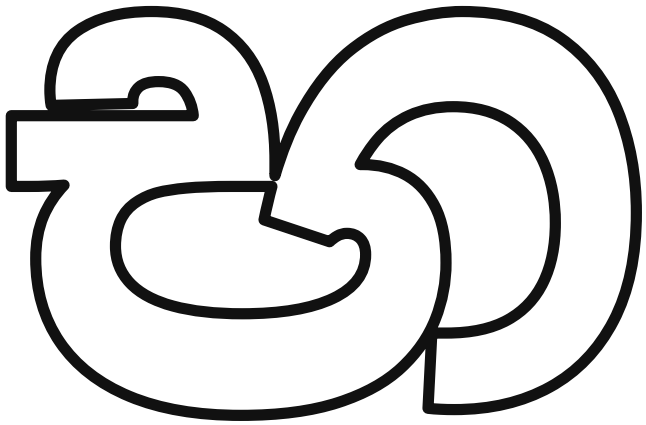
cooked rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

බ බ බ බ

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NAME · නම

මහාප්‍රාණ බයන්න

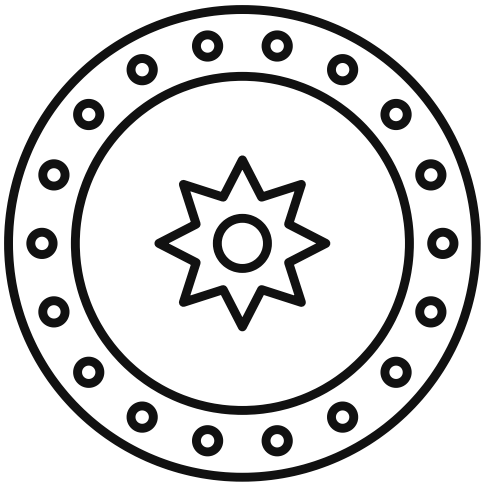
mahaapraana bayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'b' — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like බ — in careful speech, add a puff of breath

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

හ් + අ = හ



හ IS FOR

භෝජනය

bhōjanaya

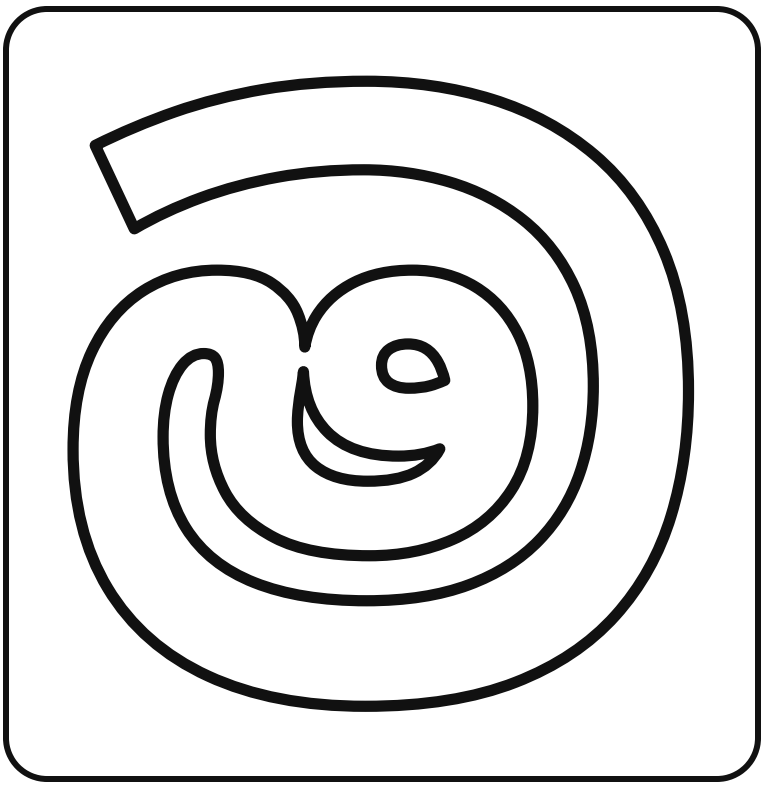
a meal

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

භ භ භ භ

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NAME · නම

මයන්න

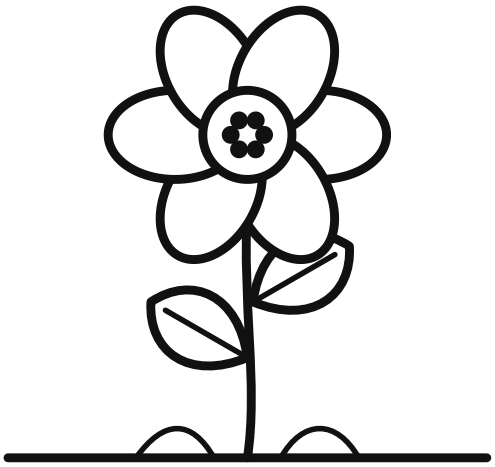
mayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

මි + අ = ම



ම IS FOR

මල

mala

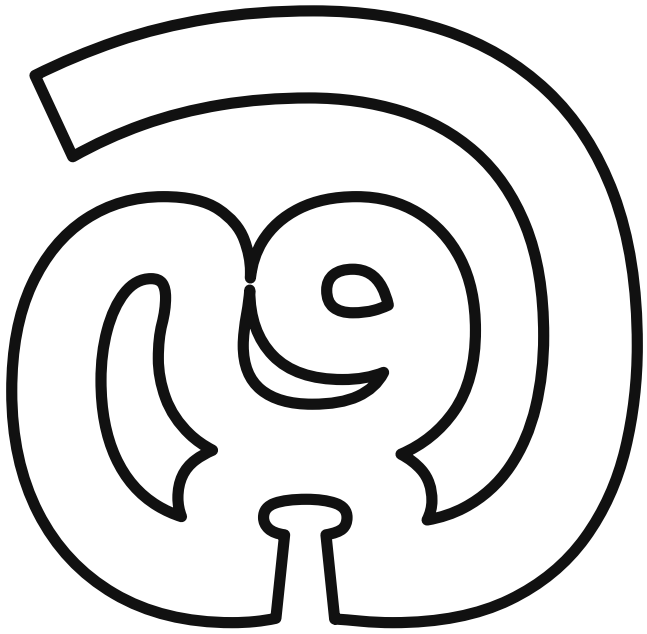
flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ම ම ම ම

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NAME · නම

අඹ බයන්න

amba bayanna

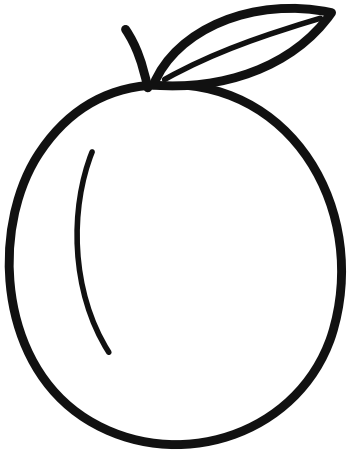
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a half-nasal ‘mb’: a tiny ‘m’ slides into ‘b’, like “number” said quickly

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ඹ් + අ = ඹ

Find ඹ inside අඹ — it hardly ever starts a word.



ඹ IS FOR

අඹ

amba

mango

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

අඹ අඹ අඹ අඹ

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ය

NAME · නම

යයන්න

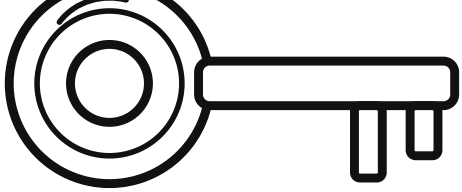
yayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'y' as in "yes"

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

යී + අ = ය



ය IS FOR

යතුර

yatura

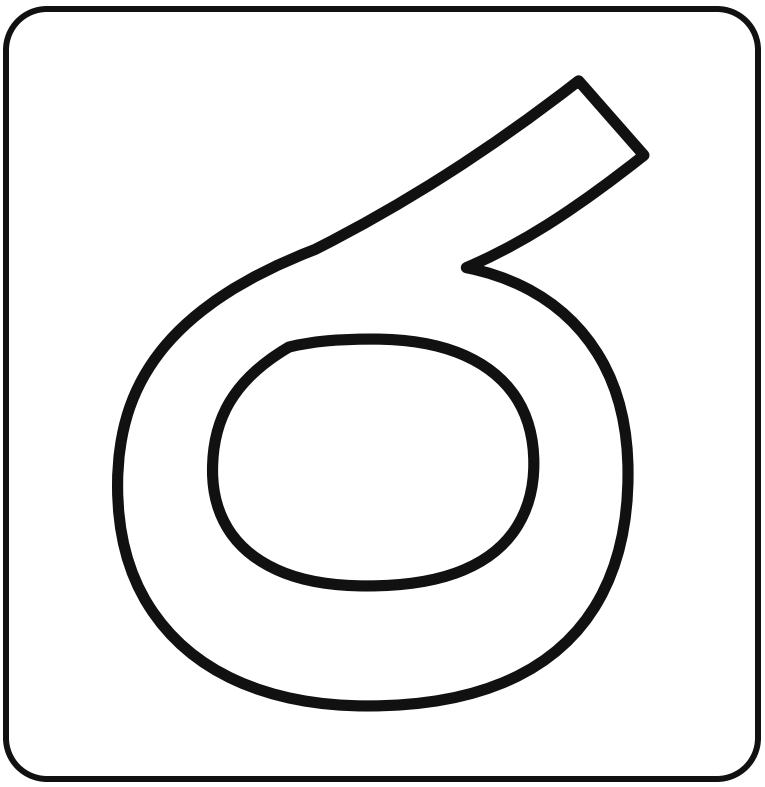
key

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ය ය ය ය

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NAME · නම

රයන්න

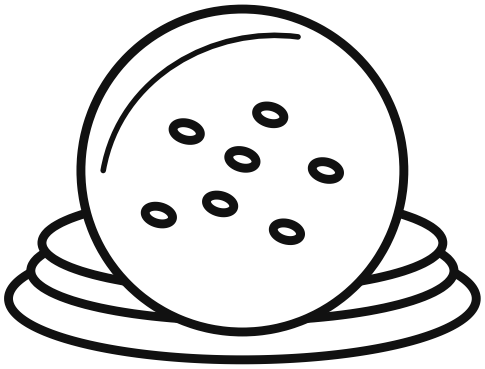
rayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a tapped ‘r’ — flick the tongue once

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ර් + අ = ර



ර IS FOR

රොටි

roṭi

flatbread (roti)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

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NAME · නම

දන්තජ ලයන්න

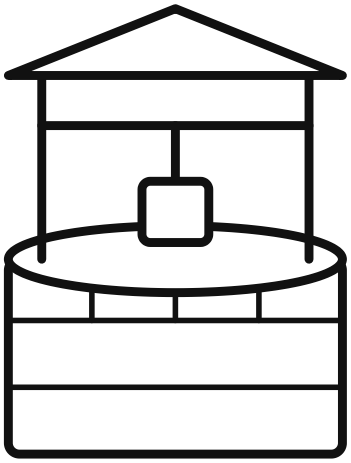
dantaja layanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ල් + අ = ල



ල IS FOR

ලිඳ

linda

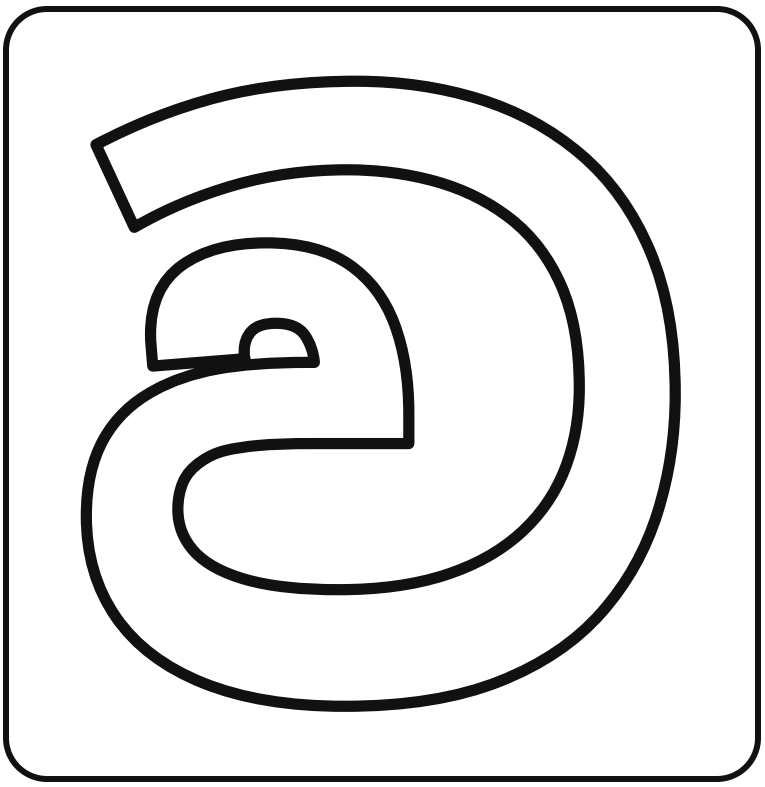
well (for water)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ල ල ල ල

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NAME · නම

වයන්න

vayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

between ‘v’ and ‘w’

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ව් + අ = ව



ව IS FOR

වැස්ස

væssa

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ව ව ව ව

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ශ

NAME · නම

තාලුජ ශයන්න

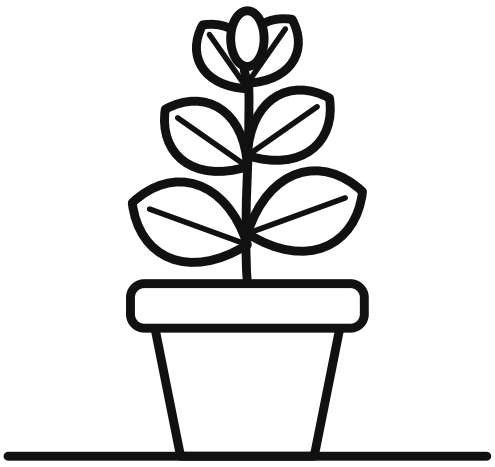
taaluja shayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'sh' as in "shoe"

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ශ් + අ = ශ



ශ IS FOR

ශාකය

shaakaya

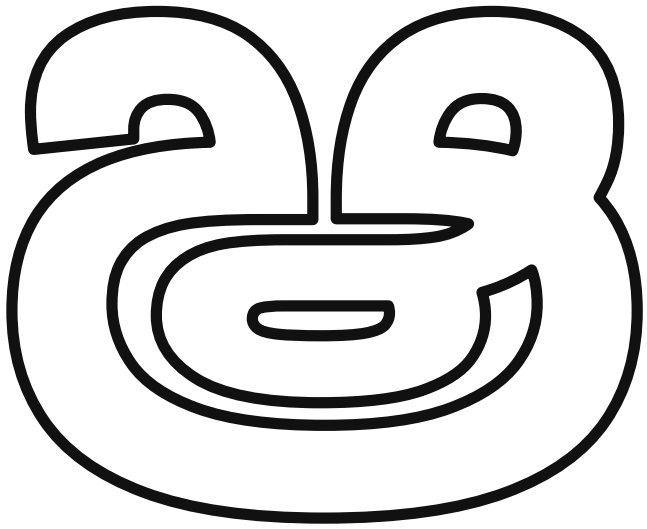
plant

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ශ ශ ශ ශ

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NAME · නම

මූර්ධජ ෂයන්න

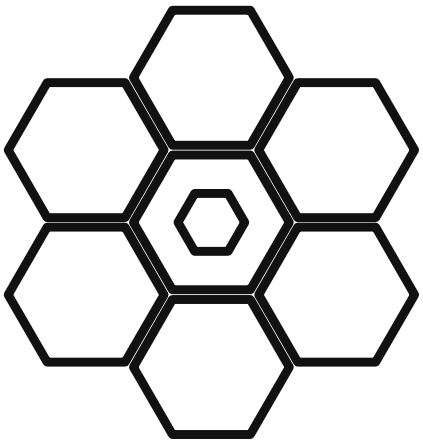
muurdhaja shayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “shoe” — the same as ශ in everyday Sinhala

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ෂ් + අ = ෂ



ෂ IS FOR

ෂඩස්‍රය

shaḍasraya

hexagon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ෂ ෂ ෂ ෂ

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ස

NAME · නම

දන්තජ සයන්න

dantaja sayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

's' as in "sun"

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ස් + අ = ස



ස IS FOR

සඳ

sanda

the moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ස ස ස ස

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හ

NAME · නම

හයන්න

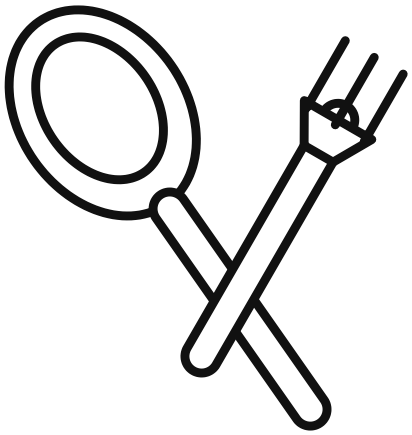
hayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'h' as in "hat"

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

හ් + අ = හ



හ IS FOR

හැන්ද

hænda

spoon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

හ හ හ හ

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ළ

NAME · නම

මූර්ධජ ළයන්න

muurdhaja ḷayanna

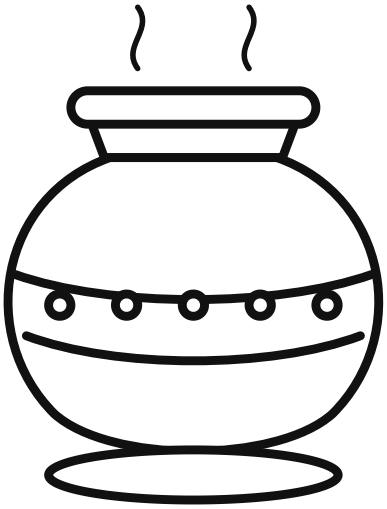
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' — in everyday Sinhala it sounds just like ල

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ල් + අ = ළ

Find ළ inside කළය — it hardly ever starts a word.



ළ IS FOR

කළය

kaḷaya

clay pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

ළ ළ ළ ළ

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ෆ

NAME · නම

ෆයන්න

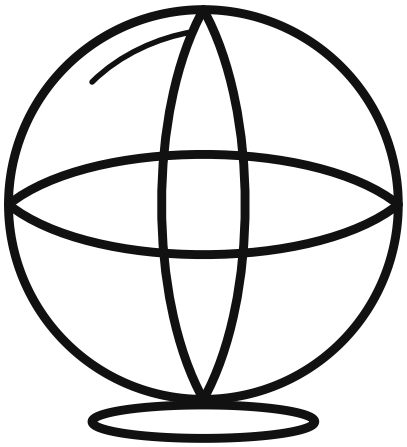
fayanna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'f' as in "fan" — a new letter for words from English

SINHALA PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ෆ් + ඇ = ෆ



ෆ IS FOR

ෆුට්බෝල්

fuṭbōl

football

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ලියන්න

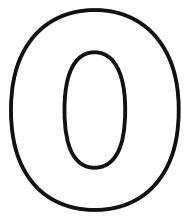
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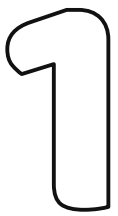
BONUS

Sinhala numbers ඉලක්කම් *(ilakkam)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Sinhala: *binduva*, *eka*, *deka*, *tuna*...



0
බින්දුව
binduva
zero



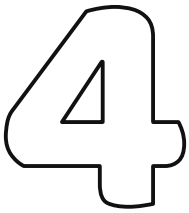
1
එක
eka
one



2
දෙක
deka
two



3
තුන
tuna
three



4
හතර
hatara
four



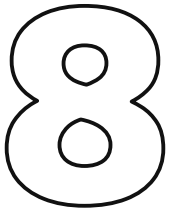
5
පහ
paha
five



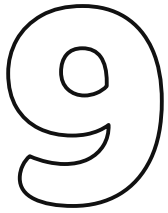
6
හය
haya
six



7
හත
hata
seven



8
අට
aṭa
eight



9
නවය
navaya
nine

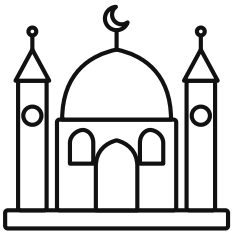
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LET'S TALK

My first Sinhala words මුල් වචන

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

අස්සලාමු අලෙකුම්	*assalaamu alaikum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
වලෙකුමුස් සලාම්	*va alaikumus salaam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
ආයුබෝවන්!	*aayubōvan!* **Hello! (“May you live long!”)**
මගේ නම ...	*magē nama ...* **My name is ...**
ස්තූතියි	*stuutiyi* **Thank you**
ජසාකල්ලාහු ඛයිරන්	*jazaakallaahu khairan* **May Allah reward you with good**
අම්මා · තාත්තා	*ammaa · taattaa* **Mother · Father**
අයියා · අක්කා	*ayyaa · akkaa* **Big brother · Big sister**
ඔව් · නැහැ	*ow · næhæ* **Yes · No**
මම සිංහල ඉගෙන ගන්නවා!	*mama sinhala igena gannavaa!* **I am learning Sinhala!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

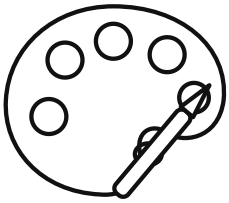
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International); official languages from the **Constitution of Sri Lanka**.

What's next?
You have met all **50 Sinhala letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Sinhala, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

මාෂා අල්ලාහ්! ඉතා හොඳයි!

maashaa allaah! itaa hondayi! — Well done, very good!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 50 letters of the Sinhala alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
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